# STANDATA variance 23-BCV-002

Building

## Review of off-site constructed buildings

Date Issued: May 2024



### Purpose

To clarify the intent of off-site review as it applies to off-site construction of buildings.

### Discussion

Off-site construction of buildings is a process of maximizing the delivery of building products as much as possible as one module/building. Currently it has become a well-suited solution to control project schedules and budgets while controlling quality and reducing environmental impact.

Regulatory compliance of off-site construction is currently addressed under Division C, Sentence 2.5.1.1.(2) of the National Building Code - 2023 Alberta Edition (NBC(AE)) by seeking certification from an accredited third party in accordance with CSA A277 “Procedure for certification of prefabricated buildings, modules, and panels”. Alberta recognizes the standard as confirming the building complies with the NBC(AE).

Method of off-site review by registered professionals and/or inspections by the authority having jurisdiction (AHJ) achieves a minimum level of performance as required by the NBC(AE) in areas defined by the code objectives. Additionally, functional statements on the acceptable solution may be considered as an alternative to achieving code compliance.

CSA-A660 “Certification of manufacturers of steel building systems” may be recognized for completed steel building modules. An additional letter of assurance by a registered professional or permit service report by an AHJ will be required for any installation of building services. (i.e., electrical, plumbing, HVAC, building envelope).

### Code References

**Division C, Article 2.5.1.1.**

**2.5.1 Factory-Built Assemblies**
**2.5.1.1. General**
1) Where a component of a *building* is assembled off the *building* site in such a manner that it cannot be reviewed on site, off-site reviews shall be carried out to determine compliance with this Code.

2) Factory-constructed and other off-site-constructed buildings that are constructed after 01 May 2024 and certified in accordance with CSA A277, “Procedure for certification of prefabricated buildings, modules, and panels,” by an organization accredited for this purpose by the Standards Council of Canada are considered to comply with this Code.

3) Every relocatable industrial camp building that is constructed after 01 May 2024 shall be certified by an organization approved for this purpose by the Provincial Building Administrator, to confirm that the building complies with the objectives and functional statements of this Code.



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**Division A, Article 1.2.1.1.**

**1.2.1.1. Compliance with this Code**
1) Compliance with this Code shall be achieved by
a) complying with the applicable acceptable solutions in Division B (see Note A-1.2.1.1.(1)(a)), or
b) using alternative solutions that will achieve at least the minimum level of performance required by Division B in the areas defined by the objectives and functional statements attributed to the applicable acceptable solutions (see Note A-1.2.1.1.(1)(b)).
2) For the purposes of compliance with this Code as required in Clause 1.2.1.1.(1)(b), the objectives and functional statements attributed to the acceptable solutions in Division B shall be the objectives and functional statements referred to in Subsection 1.1.2. of Division B.

## Application

This variance applies to off-site constructed buildings (except relocatable industrial camp buildings).

## Variance

This variance provides approximately equivalent or greater safety performance with respect to persons and property as provided for by the *Safety Codes Act* and the NBC(AE).

The following alternative methods are deemed acceptable to ensure compliance with NBC(AE) for off-site constructed buildings:

1. Certified in accordance with CSA A660 by an accredited organization with a “Certificate of Design and Manufacturing Conformance” for completed steel building modules.

2. Verified by registered architectural/engineering professionals in accordance with Division C, Subsections 2.4.2. and Section 2.5. of the NBC(AE). (i)

3. Verified through inspections by the AHJ at the location of the work being undertaken. (ii)

Notes:
(i) Design drawings, specifications, and letter of conformance imprinted with the seals or stamps of a registered professional are required for this method. Also refer to the NBC(AE) defined term ‘*field review*’ and associated appendix note.
(ii) If off-site inspection by the local authority where construction is carried out is not feasible, on-site inspection may be performed for critical items mutually agreed upon by the AHJ and permit applicant during the plan examination stage. This may be listed as a condition at the time the permit is issued.

This VARIANCE is applicable throughout the province of Alberta.

Unless stated otherwise, all Code references in this STANDATA are to Division B of the National Building Code - 2023 Alberta Edition

Issued by the Provincial Building Administrator

*[Original singed]*
Paul Chang

Alberta Municipal Affairs – Technical and Corporate Services

Email: safety.services@gov.ab.ca Phone: 1-866-421-6929

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